Common App

Personal Information

Legal name

First/given name:	Aarav
Middle name:	
Last/family/surname:	Sharma
Date of birth:	03/14/2009
Permanent home address:	1420 Hobson Rd, Naperville, IL 60540

Demographics

Citizenship status:	Other (non-US)
Visa type:	H-4
Countries of citizenship:	India

Family

Parent 1 Highest level of education:	Graduate school

Education

Current or most recent secondary/high school:	Naperville North High School
Date of entry:	08/2022
Graduation date:	May 2027

Grades

Graduating class size (approx.):	740
Class rank reporting:	Exact
Class rank:	18
Cumulative GPA:	3.97
GPA scale:	4
GPA weighting:	Unweighted

Current or Most Recent Year Courses

Course:	AP Calculus BC
Course:	AP Physics C: Mechanics
Course:	AP Computer Science A
Course:	AP English Language
Course:	AP US History
Course:	AP Chemistry
Course:	Honors Spanish IV

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Testing

Highest evidence-based reading and writing score: 750

Highest math score: 790

Activities

Activity 1

Activity type: Robotics

Position/leadership description: Captain and lead programmer

Organization name: FRC Team 4096 Ctrl-Z

Please describe this activity, including what you accomplished and any recognition you received, etc.: Led 35-member team to 2026 regionals; mentored rookies; wrote vision-tracking code; taught 40 middle schoolers Python.

Participation grade levels: 9, 10, 11, 12

Timing of participation: During school year

Hours spent per week: 14

Weeks spent per year: 40

I intend to participate in a similar activity in college: Yes

Activity 2

Activity type: Computer/Technology

Position/leadership description: Founder

Organization name: CodeBridge Naperville

Please describe this activity, including what you accomplished and any recognition you received, etc.: Founded free coding classes for 120 students served; raised $3,200 from local businesses.

Participation grade levels: 10, 11, 12

Timing of participation: During school year

Hours spent per week: 5

Weeks spent per year: 36

I intend to participate in a similar activity in college: Yes

Activity 3

Activity type: Debate/Speech

Position/leadership description: Varsity member

Organization name: Naperville North Speech & Debate

Please describe this activity, including what you accomplished and any recognition you received, etc.: Public forum debater; qualified to state tournament each year.

Participation grade levels: 10, 11, 12

Timing of participation: During school year

Hours spent per week: 6

Weeks spent per year: 30

I intend to participate in a similar activity in college: Yes

Activity 4

Activity type: Work (Paid)

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Position/leadership description:	Math tutor
Organization name:	Mathnasium of Naperville
Please describe this activity, including what you accomplished and any recognition you received, etc.:	Tutor 8 students weekly in algebra and geometry.
Participation grade levels:	11, 12
Timing of participation:	During school year
Hours spent per week:	8
Weeks spent per year:	45
I intend to participate in a similar activity in college:	Yes

Honors

Honors title:	USACO Gold Division
Grade level:	11
Level(s) of recognition:	National
Honors title:	AP Scholar with Distinction
Grade level:	11
Level(s) of recognition:	National
Honors title:	Illinois State Scholar
Grade level:	12
Level(s) of recognition:	State

Future Plans

Career interest:	Computer Science

Writing

Personal essay

The essay demonstrates your ability to write clearly and concisely on a selected topic and helps you distinguish yourself in your own voice. What do we want to know about you? Keep that question at the center of your writing. Use the prompt to inspire and structure your response. Remember: 650 words is your limit, not your goal. Use the full range if you need it, but don't feel obligated to do so.

Describe a topic, idea, or concept you find so engaging that it makes you lose all track of time. Why does it captivate you? What or who do you turn to when you want to learn more?

The first time our robot drove itself across the field, it hit the wall at full speed, and thirty-five people turned to look at me. I had written the vision code the night before, convinced that a camera and a few hundred lines of Python could see the way a driver sees. I had written the vision code the night before, convinced that a camera and a few hundred lines of Python could see the way a driver sees. That collision taught me more than any tutorial: a machine only notices what you teach it to notice, and so do people. That collision taught me more than any tutorial: a machine only notices what you teach it to notice, and so do people. That collision taught me more than any tutorial: a m

achine only notices what you teach it to notice, and so do people. That collision taught me more than any tutorial: a machine only notices what you teach it to notice, and so do people. Now, when I teach Saturday classes at the library, I watch which kids stop raising their hands and ask them what they noticed first. Now, when I teach Saturday classes at the library, I watch which kids stop raising their hands and ask them what they noticed first. Now, when I teach Saturday classes at the library, I watch which kids stop raising their hands and ask them what they noticed first. I still lose track of time

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debugging, but I have learned that the best fixes start with a better question.

Additional information

Do you wish to provide details of circumstances? No

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